

HOUSE No. 2467

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

Meghan K. Kilcoyne

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act to study the decriminalization of sex work.

PETITION OF:

NAME:	DISTRICT/ADDRESS:	DATE ADDED:
<i>Meghan K. Kilcoyne</i>	<i>12th Worcester</i>	<i>1/17/2025</i>
<i>Mike Connolly</i>	<i>26th Middlesex</i>	<i>3/14/2025</i>
<i>Samantha Montaño</i>	<i>15th Suffolk</i>	<i>3/14/2025</i>
<i>Patrick Joseph Kearney</i>	<i>4th Plymouth</i>	<i>4/7/2025</i>
<i>Jack Patrick Lewis</i>	<i>7th Middlesex</i>	<i>6/17/2025</i>
<i>Tara T. Hong</i>	<i>18th Middlesex</i>	<i>6/30/2025</i>
<i>James B. Eldridge</i>	<i>Middlesex and Worcester</i>	<i>7/23/2025</i>

HOUSE No. 2467

By Representative Kilcoyne of Clinton, a petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 2467) of Meghan K. Kilcoyne for legislation to establish an interagency committee to study decriminalizing sex work. Public Health.

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act to study the decriminalization of sex work.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 SECTION 19. Chapter 272 of the General Laws is hereby amended by adding after
2 section

3 53B the following section, which shall be titled “Interagency committee to study
4 decriminalizing sex work”:-

5 Section 53C. (a) There shall be an interagency committee to be convened by the
6 Executive

7 Office of Health and Human Services within 90 days from the date of the enactment of
8 this

9 provision to study decriminalizing sex work. The committee shall consist of: (i) the
10 secretary of the Executive Office of Health and Human Services or the secretary’s

designee; (ii) a representative of the Department of Public Health; (iii) a representative of the Executive Office of Labor and Workforce Development; (iv) a representative of the Department of Housing and Community Development; (v) a representative of the Department of Children and Families; (vi) a representative from an organization focused on advocacy for sex workers; (vii) a representative from an organization focused on advocating for transgender people and racial justice; (ix) a survivor or direct service provider from an organization representing survivors of human trafficking in the commercial sex sector; (x) representative from the Boston Area Rape Crisis Center; (xi) a representative from the American Civil Liberties Union of Massachusetts; (xii) a representative from an organization focused on harm reduction related to substance use; (xiii) a representative from an organization focused on advocating for legal defense and bonds for undocumented people; (xiv) a representative from the Committee for Public Counsel Services; and (xv) at least three current or former sex workers. The members of the committee shall be appointed by the secretary of the Executive Office of Health and Human Services or the secretary's designee unless otherwise stated. Two co-chairs shall

be appointed by majority vote of commission members. Adequate compensation for services shall be determined by a schedule of fees adopted by the committee.

The committee shall be responsible for studying and making recommendations towards the following: (i) what criminal penalties and collateral consequences exist related to the criminalization of sex work, (ii) what labor protections need to be in place under decriminalization, (iii) what services need to be made available to people engaged in commercial sex to improve health and safety outcomes, (iv) identify the methods of human trafficking and exploitation in order to develop strategies to reduce these activities in collaboration with sex workers, with a focus on prevention, (v) implementation models for alternatives to policing to promote safety in the commercial sex sector, rooted in public health, and (vi) the development of a fund to prevent, reduce, prevent, and eliminate human trafficking that shall include ways to support the health, safety, and autonomy of sex workers.